בס"ד

ZEKELMAN STANDARDS

2.5

FOR JUDAIC STUDIES

Chumash

Complete Version – Levels 1-8

A PROJECT OF

menachem

EDUCATION FOUNDATION

בס"ד

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2.5
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Chumash

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menachem

EDUCATION FOUNDATION

ORIGINAL STANDARDS PROJECT DIRECTED BY

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Based on feedback from schools 2017-2025

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Table of Contents

Overview 4
I About the Zekelman Standards 5
II Letter from Our Executive Director 6
III Introduction to Version 2.0 7
IV Portrait of a Student 9
V Using the Standards 10
VI Additional Resources 12
VII What Standards are Not 13

1. תורה שבכתב Essentials 14
1.01 – 1.02 The Nature and Purpose of תורה שבכתב 15
1.03 – 1.06 תנ"ך Conventions 18
1.07 – 1.10 Text Referencing Skills 21
2. חומש Content 24
2.01 – 2.04 Concrete Knowledge 25
2.05 – 2.06 Conceptual Knowledge 27
3. Vocabulary and Language Skills 28
3.01 – 3.03 Vocabulary 30
3.04 – 3.07 Parts of Speech 33
3.08 – 3.09 Syntax 47
3.10 Understanding ניקוד 50
4. Passage Comprehension 52
4.01 – 4.02 Finding Information 53
4.03 – 4.07 Higher Order Thinking 55
4.08 Integrating Knowledge 58
5. רש"י Skills 59
5.01 – 5.04 Reading and Language Skills 60
5.05 – 5.08 רש"י Comprehension Skills 62
6. מפרשים 65
Appendices 68

In Appreciation

The Zekelman Standards were created through the remarkable generosity of its patrons Mr. Alan and Lori Zekelman, passionate advocates for Jewish education. While Mr. Zekelman has emerged as a preeminent entrepreneur and philanthropist involved with numerous charitable activities, he has graciously undertaken a paramount role in securing a bright Jewish future by endowing the Zekelman Standards project and bringing standards and educational excellence to every Jewish student. His efforts to foster greater Jewish pride, education and continuity are already making their mark in classrooms across America. The Zekelman Standards are dedicated in loving memory of Mr. Zekelman's parents, יחזקל בן אברהם אהרן and רות בת אברהם.

The Menachem Education Foundation

The Menachem Education Foundation's mission is to ensure the best quality Chinuch for Chabad students all over the world. For nearly a decade, we have been working with schools, teachers and lay leaders to improve school systems and provide opportunities for growth. The Zekelman Standards for Judaic Studies is one of the ways in which we strive to ensure that every child can access his or her Torah heritage to their utmost potential.

Zekelman Standards for Chumash 2.5

Version 2.5 of the Zekelman Standards for Chumash acknowledges the many schools that have implemented the standards from 2017 to date. Their experience in the classroom, with the guidance of Dr Sara Rosenfeld, led to some tweaks that have taken into account the practicality, of language acquisition and some of the challenges faced by English speaking students when engaging with Chumash texts. Key changes include acknowledging that not all schools begin Chumash in Year 1. Thus, we have changed the division of standards to Levels, acknowledging that students may begin Level 1 at varying different Grade levels. Whether this is a whole school approach, a guide for the special education department, or a roadmap for students coming into school in mid-elementary or later, emphasizing levels rather than grades, puts the focus on the progression of skills rather than a particular age group.

A number of specific language skills have been adjusted to begin at one Level higher than originally envisioned based on real experience in schools.

I. About the Zekelman Standards for Chumash

How do we gauge the success of our teaching? More importantly, how do we know if we are doing our job as educators, and if we are doing it effectively?

It is clear that it would be futile to embark on a road trip, map and provisions in hand, without any idea of where you are going. Similarly, the only way for teaching to be considered successful is when the teacher has clear goals in mind. As clearly articulated benchmarks for mastery in each subject, learning standards tell us where we are headed in the journey of education, and give us a means to determine our success.

The Menachem Education Foundation, with the self-stated mission of professionalizing education in Jewish schools, has taken up the cause of learning standards and facilitated an unprecedented collaborative effort among educators across the globe to develop them. Many of the standards incorporate cognitive skills and various levels of Bloom's Taxonomy; and we have customized the framework and content of learning standards for use in the unique arena of Judaic subjects.

At the Menachem Education Foundation, we believe that all Jewish students should have the opportunity to master the academic skills necessary for self-sufficiency in Torah study, confident engagement with Torah text, and joyous pursuit of lifelong Jewish learning and living in all areas. The Zekelman Standards for Chumash were created to make these goals a reality, for EVERY child, in EVERY school.

These standards form a living document. They were created through extensive deliberation, the input of a variety of educational professionals, and real-time feedback from teachers who have used them. Over the past years, these standards have been continuously examined, revised, and updated, as new minds joined its team of contributors and new data from schools and classrooms emerged. In 2014, the standards were completed through grade 8 for the first time, and in 2017, a new layer of review and revision yielded the Zekelman Standards for Chumash 2.0. Now in 2025, Version 2.5 includes further updates that have been made as more data is gathered from schools implementing these standards.

By using these standards, you are becoming a member in the process of establishing a standard for the learning that takes place in our schools. We hope to hear from you, and wish you much success in your journey of teaching.

II. Letter from the Executive Director

It is with tremendous gratitude to Hashem that I present to *mechanchim* and *mechanchos* world-wide this second edition of the Zekelman Standards for Chumash.

The standards were conceived of in 2010 and their first edition completed in 2014. During that time, and even more so since their completion, the standards have profoundly influenced the way teachers approach Chumash in tens of schools throughout the world, and have been acclaimed by educators across the spectrum of Torah communities.

With a handful of trailblazing schools leading the way - and credit is especially due to Yeshiva Schools of Pittsburgh, PA; Cheder Menachem of Los Angeles, CA; and Yeshiva - Beth Rivkah Colleges of Melbourne, AU - yeshivas, days schools, and other programs across the spectrum of Orthodox schooling have recognized the benefit of clear benchmarks for Chumash learning. Each adapting these benchmarks to their own setting and student body's needs, they are able to plan curriculum in a way that promotes learning instead of just covering ground, to assess student learning in a way that empowers teachers to adapt and differentiate the curriculum, and to view independent and inspired Chumash learning an attainable goal for every student.

The greatest strength of these standards is their adaptability. A teacher selecting just one standard, in one class, to focus on in a systematic way is building a skill that students will be able to retain. A school providing professional development in one area of the standards is raising the bar for teaching and learning and encouraging professional conversation that will spill over to other areas. If nothing else, commitment to a cycle of goal-setting, assessment and evaluation - the essence of standards based learning - is transformative.

Thus, it is my honor to thank the dynamic team of educators who authored, piloted, revised and championed these standards over the past seven years. **Rabbi Yossi Rosenblum**, the project's director, is blessed with educational vision which sparked this project and continues to fuel its progress, and **Dr. Sara Rosenfeld**'s knowledge and expertise imbues this project with integrity and comprehensiveness. **Rabbi Mendy Greenbaum** and **Rabbi Meir Perelstein**, in addition to their co-authorship of the standards, have shown how they can come to life in very different school settings, helping every kind of student. **Mrs. Chanah Rose**, as MEF's Educational Director, brings a holistic view of the whole child's needs to the picture, as well as the evolving needs of the schools we work with.

A boundless debt of gratitude is owed to my dear friend, **Mr. Alan Zekelman** and his wife **Lori**, who endowed this project and propelled it forward at every stage. Their commitment to excellence in Chinuch is unparalleled. May the success in learning of hundreds of Jewish children provide you with continued *nachas*, as it is the only and best way that we can say thank you.

Rabbi Zalman Shneur

Founder and Executive Director

Menachem Education Foundation – 1 Adar, 5777

III. Introduction to the Zekelman Standards for Chumash 2.0

The Zekelman Standards for Chumash present a significant milestone for Torah educators, but not necessarily an innovation. A closer look at our sources shows that an approach to Chumash that is based on skills and mastery, as opposed to coverage alone, is deeply rooted in in our heritage.

The Maharal, commenting[1] on the word "Veshinantam" which connotes fluency and ownership, notes the unfortunate prevalence in his day of a rushed approach to Limud HaTorah. He refers to the Mishna in Avos[2] that delineates a sequential approach to Torah study: *ben chamesh limikra, ben eser limishna,* and so forth. He bemoans the fact that that students are rushed to cover ground and go from one level to the next without taking the time to ensure that they have acquired the proper foundation for the next stage in learning. After all that, they leave Yeshiva not having "acquired" the Torah - in the sense of a "*kinyan*," connoting fluency and comprehension. The Maharal underscores the importance of a sequence that makes mastery of each step a prerequisite to the next, and this is the conceptual foundation of learning standards.

A few centuries later, the Alter Rebbe made a ruling along similar lines in Hilchos Talmud Torah. In today's day and age, wrote the Alter Rebbe, it is more important for students to learn some Gemara deeply, than a lot of Gemara without the accompanying analysis. The reason for this is that educators need to equip students with the ability to learn in depth on their own, even after leaving Yeshiva.

Earlier in this monumental work[3], the Alter Rebbe compares two prototypes of a teacher. One is conscientious about accuracy and careful to check for student comprehension, but does not cover a lot of material (even out of negligence). The second teacher covers much more ground but does not pay careful attention to detail and comprehension. If there is a choice between two such candidates, the first teacher - the slower but more methodical one - is the one for the job.

The Zekelman Standards for Chumash reflect the Alter Rebbe's definition of successful teaching, and assist teachers in fulfilling their task. The standards delineate benchmarks for comprehension (in Standard 4), and for the skills necessary for independent learning. They also make assessment and checks for understanding possible, by providing teachers with points of reference by which to set and evaluate learning goals for students.

Subsequent generations of Chabad Rebbeim have emphasized that this kind of Torah study is applicable to *every student.* The Lubavitcher Rebbe directed the following strong words of his predecessor, the Frierdiker Rebbe, to an educator:

> *A good teacher does not mean one who teaches concepts to his student, but one who teaches in such a way that [the student] himself can learn; and not only does he succeed with a diligent and conscientious student, but he is a proactive teacher, achieving success with a student who is slothful and lacking talent as well.*[4]

The systematic implementation of standards makes true success in learning possible for every student in every school. The Rebbe often emphasized that the tumultuous influences of today's world require that schools take new levels of responsibility for the success of the

[1] גור ארי-ה פרשת ואתחנן, פרק ו

[2] פרק ה, משנה כא

[3] פרק א, הלכה יא. See also תלמוד בבלי מסכת בבא בתרא דף כא עמוד א

[4] אגרות קדש, כ"ז טבת תשי"ב

whole child. We clearly see that a student's success in learning, and resulting sense of confidence and self-worth, is often a pivotal factor in his or her choices for life after graduation.

In a Sicha on Parshas Mishpatim,[5] the Rebbe asks why yeshivos do not teach the Klalei Hatalmud of Shmuel Hanagid, which present a systematic approach to the logic of Gemara. The Rebbe acknowledges that this has not been done before, and that he himself was not taught that way, but negates the possibility that this is a precedent that should be relied upon. In other words, if something is necessary and clearly beneficial for Chinuch (as the Rebbe illustrates in this Sicha with a systematic approach to Gemara learning), the fact that it has not been done before is no reason not to put it in practice! If the need is clear, then the time is now, and "this is not the way we were taught" is neither an excuse nor a justification why not to do it.

The Zekelman Standards for Chumash are presented to guide teachers in leading their students through sequential mastery of the different steps required for successful Torah study. Their aim is singular: to bolster Torah study in our schools and Yeshivos in order to strengthen our students' connection to Torah and Hakadosh Baruch Hu. Let us accept the mandate that our heritage and our Rebbeim have given us, and teach our children Chumash in a way that enables and inspires them to continue to learn it and live it, for life.

Rabbi Yossi Rosenblum

Director, Zekelman Standards Project

1 Adar, 5777

[5] תורת מנחם page 1261

IV. Portrait of a Student

The Zekelman Standards for Chumash were created with the following vision for eighth grade Yeshiva school graduates in mind.

1. They can **independently learn** – decode, translate, and comprehend – significant portions of חומש text. They can identify new information given, conceptualize textual narratives, and integrate the "פשט" meaning that the חומש conveys. They can comfortably orient themselves in the text of the חומש, in order to conduct research, find desired locations, and easily navigate between different places in the חומש.

2. They **engage intellectually** with the חומש text. They can identify deviations in the text and its conventions, and articulate appropriate questions about such deviations. They can analyze the text, in order to glean nuances which allow them to reconcile puzzling aspects of the plain text, and in order to construe a deeper and subtler understanding of what the חומש is saying.

3. They are comfortable with מפרשים **as guides** and companions in their learning journey. They have the skills to locate, read and understand a number of מפרשים – including, most fundamentally, רש"י – and can integrate the commentary's insights and additions into their comprehension of the text. They can identify when to turn to a particular מפורש for a particular purpose, and they use the thought processes of the מפרשים for further analysis and ever deeper comprehension of and engagement with the text.

4. They possess a comprehensive and involved familiarity with a significant portion of חומש texts, topics and narratives. The **knowledge gleaned** from their eight years of learning חומש will form the scaffolding for their greater Judaic knowledge and further learning.

5. They approach the study of חומש and other תורה texts with value for their **role, relevance, and holiness,** integrated throughout their eight years of learning *about* the חומש, both from the teacher and from the חומש itself, and interacting with the חומש in positive ways.

6. They possess **moral, spiritual, and intellectual** understandings, gleaned from deep and meaningful study of a variety of selections within the text of the חומש. These understandings, now integrated into the students' personality, character and intelligence, are a prism through which to approach continued learning, and life situations.

7. Their fluency in, comfort with, and integration of all of the components of חומש study mastered over eight years of learning enables them to:

    a. Have the **confidence** that will contribute to **motivation** to tackle additional texts of increasing challenge, both in חומש and other areas of תורה.

    b. Integrate study of חומש (and, by extension, other areas of תורה) **into their own person**, as a cherished, valued and enjoyable activity to be proactively and independently pursued.

V. Using the Standards

The Zekelman Standards for Chumash are designed in a similar fashion to the Common Core Standards developed by educators for teaching secular studies. Many of our standards overlap with the Common Core Standards, incorporating essential cognitive and learning skills, and all of the levels of Bloom's taxonomy.

We have added an additional layer to our standards in order to pre-empt the problem of what educators call "unpacking the standards." In order to help teachers understand the standards and make them usable in the classroom, we incorporated Enduring Understandings, Essential Questions and Key Knowledge (three components of the curriculum model Understanding by Design).

With this background in mind, you can now approach the actual standards, which, with some variation, are organized in the following way:

1. **Enduring Understandings (EUs)** These are full sentences which are called Enduring Understandings because they present principles that endure beyond the classroom and often beyond the actual subject being studied. They are overarching conceptual understandings which underpin large parts of the student's learning. The EUs are not actually verbalized by the teacher in class. Rather, they are discovered and understood by the students as a result of the content explored, discussed or reached as a result of the specific content that you convey. Keep EUs in mind throughout your teaching, with the goal of conveying them through the means of your curriculum.
2. **Essential Questions (EQs)** A question becomes an essential question when it meets the following criteria:
    a. It gets to the heart of the material under discussion or is needed for learning core content.
    b. It is thought provoking and stimulates rethinking of big ideas, assumptions and prior lessons.
    c. It has no 'simple' right answer but is meant to be argued and defended with numerous examples.
    d. It can be asked repeatedly, within the same year and over the years.
    e. It often leads to further questions.

    Essential questions are posed by the teacher in a recurring fashion. Select EQs, dependent on the content and skill being studied in any one lesson, should be visible on the classroom walls or on the board. It is expected that students will eventually ask themselves these questions as they study the text. Our lists of EQs corresponding to each EU (see above) are not exhaustive, and we often provided several examples for each. Feel free to think of more that meet the above criteria.

3. **Key Knowledge** The key knowledge preceding each standard area lays out the fundamentals underlying all of the sub-standards in that area. In many cases, these include grammar rules, or essential facts, which are beyond the scope of particular standards but are necessary for the students to know in order to be able to perform the skill outlined in the actual standards. Teachers should become thoroughly familiar with the key knowledge, even if some of it surpasses the scope of the skills which that teacher's grade must master. This will ensure that the teacher possesses a complete understanding of the subject matter at hand, and can then choose which aspects of the key knowledge to explicitly teach to their class.
4. **Scope and Sequence** This section is the main part of the standards document. After the understandings, questions and knowledge introducing each area of the standards, you will find a table which lays out what is considered to be mastery of that particular area of learning, for each grade. If a particular item is extended beyond one grade, continue to assess it to ensure retention for as long as it extends.
5. **Hebrew Terms and Expressions** Throughout the standards, we have used Hebrew terms, expressions, and מאמרי חז"ל. A teacher should use this vocabulary while teaching the corresponding standards, and assess the students for mastery of this vocabulary in addition to its concurrent skills. A list of all assessable terms and expressions can be found in the Appendix.
6. **Appendices** Understanding and using these standards requires the help of some background information, further elaboration, and reference pages. These are included in the extensive appendices to this document.

Using the primary components of Data Driven Instruction – assessment, analysis, and action – will help you ensure that your students continue to progress towards mastery of these standards. Assessments have an additional benefit for the teacher – they clarify and refine our expectations of a student. Whenever you are unsure about how to teach a particular standard, think about how you will assess it. Additional resources provided by the Menachem Education Foundation can assist you in implementing both the *what* – the Chumash Standards – and the *how* – Data Driven Instruction – that comprise standards based learning at its best.

VI. Additional Resources

Having these standards in your hands is just the beginning. As you browse through them, you may be thinking of the various forms of support that would help make it easier for you to implement these standards. At the Menachem Education Foundation, we work tirelessly to glean the needs of teachers and schools on the ground and to develop and curate services and resources that would fill them. Here are some things that can aid you in your implementation of standards based teaching, and link you to a community of like-minded educators who are all on a similar journey. The list is always growing.

1. **ZekelmanStandards.org** This website is the online, cutting edge home of the standards and their resources. Here, you can customize your view of the standards, navigating them by grade or by standard, in order to focus your work. You can also access a constantly growing library of resources to aid you in their implementation. These include teacher aids such as training videos and curriculum maps; downloadable resources such as flashcards, posters, templates and suggested classroom activities; and curriculum workbooks and teacher's guides available for you to order. Join a growing community of hundreds of users dedicated to best quality Chinuch.
2. **Online Assessment** A key foundation of standards based learning is authentic assessment – assessment which does not simply assign a grade to a student, but gives the teacher and student valuable information about what has and has not been mastered, so that they can now do something about it. A question bank of hundreds of high quality assessment items, access to other schools' standards based assessments, and instantly generated data reports all work together to give you the information you need to make data-based teaching decisions, minus the paperwork.
3. **Consultation** Standards based learning is a journey, and you may find that you would like to avail yourself of an experienced guide. MEF provides a team of consultants who can help customize your plan for standards deployment, and coach you along the way, based on a combination of the experiences of other schools who have implemented the standards and insight into the unique needs of your school. Workshops and professional development can also be organized and customized to keep your entire team on the same page and spark team learning.
4. **Deployment Guide** For school leaders administrations, the "how" of standards implementation may be foremost in your mind. Based on extensive interviews with leaders of standards based schools, this handbook gives you a twelve step guide, and is available for download on ZekelmanStandards.org.
5. **Contact Us** Is there something that would make standards implementation easier that is not on this list? We're listening. Contact us to suggest resources, share successes, and find out what else is in the works for educators like you: Info@ZekelmanStandards.org / 718-663-7215.

VII. What Standards are Not

As much as it is important to understand what the standards are, it is important to understand what they are not. For example, standards do not lock teachers into particular curriculum content or teaching methods, taking away their creative autonomy. Standards also do not do the teaching in the teacher's stead, taking away the educator's responsibility. The following are particular areas which will require your separate attention while using these standards.

1. **Syllabus** These standards are not specific to any particular syllabus. They can be taught using any *parsha* or *perek* of Chumash. However, since many schools teach the Chumashim of Bereishis and Shemos in grades 1-8, some details of the standards are based upon the assumption that that is the syllabus you will most likely be using.

   On the other hand, bear in mind that these standards value quality over quantity. Using them properly might slow down your teaching in the sense that less material will be covered. You may want to rethink your syllabus in this light, but the reward will certainly be worthwhile.

2. **Curriculum** Standards are not the same thing as a curriculum. They do not tell you what to teach, nor how to teach it, rather they indicate the benchmarks that students should have attained at the end of each year of their schooling. It is up to the teachers and the curriculum coordinators of each school to determine the curriculum and the teaching methods which will ensure that these standards are met, and it is up to each teacher to take ownership of the components of Chumash mastery in order to ensure that it takes place for each student.

   As such, it would be self-defeating to provide teachers with end-product curricula without empowering teachers to engage with the standards themselves. However, we do wish to support teachers in this process, and are building a growing database of curricular resources and suggested teaching strategies for teachers to work with.

3. **Assessments** Standards are the destination for the journey of learning Chumash, but it is up to the teacher to make sure that every student keeps up on that road. To this end, it is crucial for a teacher to create and administer assessments to gauge each student's progress. As mentioned earlier, standards are designed to be assessable and to work in conjunction with assessments.

Standard based assessments form the first step of a three part process called Data Driven Instruction (DDI). The second and third steps are to analyze assessment results, and create action plans based on the data gleaned, in order to ensure that each student will attain mastery. The Menachem Education Foundation promotes the implementation of DDI as the best way to ensure the success of standard based learning. Additional resources to support standards based curriculum and assessment can be found at www.ZekelmanStandards.org.

1. תורה שבכתב Essentials

This standard includes information about: the nature of תורה שבכתב, the approach one needs to learn it effectively, how to navigate it and the key concepts and ideas that determine how the books, chapters and verses are organized. Some of the information should be taught as introductory units while other information should be taught as it appears.

The Nature and Purpose of תורה שבכתב

The student will be able to demonstrate an increasing understanding of the Divine origins of the תורה and how this affects its study.

- *Please be aware that the ideas covered here are not a complete exposition of the* השקפה *related to* תורה *study. Rather, we suggested those concepts which are prerequisites to* חומש *study, at the grade levels we are dealing with here.*
- *Additionally, the scope and sequence for these ideas are not exhaustive. Please view them as a suggested guideline for reinforcing these ideas in the classroom, and use your own creativity and insight to reinforce them further.*

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. Learning תורה is a unique opportunity to unite with ה'.	1. Why spend so much time learning חומש? / Why do we study what is no longer practiced?
2. תורה is eternal and unchanging.	2. What is the relationship between תורה and science? What kinds of questions should we be asking?
3. תורה is the only absolute truth.	
4. The language of חומש is לשון הקודש, the G-dly language with which ה' created the world. תורה is written very concisely, with every detail and juxtaposition of events/narratives/הלכות having untold and sacred significance.	3. Are details important? / Does sequence matter?

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
5. תורה is ה's infinite wisdom and can never be fully understood, while also allowing for multiple levels of understanding. (פרד"ס)	4. Can questions have more than one answer?/ Is there more than one way to explain this?/ How can different opinions both be true? (Upper grades – what does חסידות add to our understanding?)
6. תורה שבעל פה and תורה שבכתב are two parts of one whole, fully dependent on one another.	5. How do we know that? / [If I don't see the information in the חומש,] Who said so? / Where does it say that? / Why didn't the חומש say this explicitly?
7. ה' gave us the rules and tools to learn the Torah; these are also part of Torah. (Upper grades)	6. Can I make up my own interpretation?
8. ה' transmitted His whole תורה to us through משה רבינו, at הר סיני.	7. Why did we need משה רבינו? / Who wrote the תורה? / When was it written?
9. As the blueprint of creation, תורה is relevant in all areas of life and everything in the world is contained within it. (אסתכל באורייתא... הפך בה והפך...)	8. What does the תורה say about this issue/topic?
10. תורה is ה' communicating to humans; guiding our lives and teaching us lessons. (It is not primarily a history book).	9. What does this teach me? / How is this relevant to my own life?
11. When applying תורה to our personal lives, we should use the guidance of other תורה sources to be sure that we are taking a lesson that is in the spirit of what the תורה intends.	
12. What happened to our אבות is a precursor for what will happen to the Jewish people in the future, and gives us the כח to endure similar challenges. (מעשה אבות סימן לבנים - חומש בראשית)	10. Why does the תורה record some events while leaving out others? / Why are these stories so important?

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.01 חכמתו ורצונו של הקב"ה							
A. Relates to a ספר of חומש with respect and affection as prescribed by הלכה and מנהג (such as kissing the חומש after use and not putting it on the floor).							

<table>
<tr><th>Level 1</th><th>Level 2</th><th>Level 3</th><th>Level 4</th><th>Level 5</th><th>Level 6</th><th>Level 7</th><th>Level 8</th></tr>
<tr><td colspan="8">B. Relates to study of חומש with appropriate reverence, as reflected in conduct according to הלכה and דרך ארץ (such as washing נעגל וואסער and saying ברכות התורה before learning, and sitting respectfully).[6]</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">C. Knows that time spent learning תורה is an opportunity to fulfill the מצוה (and daily חיוב of לימוד תורה.)</td><td colspan="4">C. Describes the תורה as חכמתו ורצונו של הקב"ה, and Torah study as an opportunity to connect with ה' (as a “meeting of minds,” so to speak).</td><td colspan="2">C. Explains that תורה study is an opportunity to achieve a singular unity with ה'.[7]</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">D. Identifies the חומש texts as the identical text found in other printed חומשים or in a ספר תורה.</td><td colspan="4">D. Knows that every ספר תורה has been copied from a pre-existing ספר תורה, all the way back to the first one that was written by משה רבינו in the מדבר. Therefore the text of all ספרי תורה throughout the world, and throughout the ages, is always the same.</td><td colspan="2">D. Explains the main ideas of the 8th and 9th principles of the י"ג עקרי אמונה's רמב"ם concerning the Divine origin and unchanging nature of תורה.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2"></td><td colspan="2">E. Says, “I don’t understand,” instead of “it doesn’t make sense.”</td><td colspan="6">E. Asks, “How can we understand this better?” and looks for possible solutions, rather than disagreeing or making judgmental statements.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">F. Knows that there is an orderly sequence to חומש that is usually chronological.</td><td colspan="5">F. Knows that there are sometimes deviations in the order of the חומש, to bring out other messages than chronology, and quotes the מחז"ל "אין מוקדם ומאוחר בתורה".</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3"></td><td colspan="5">G. Knowns that פרשיות are placed in particular order for particular reasons and this juxtaposition is called סמיכות הפרשיות.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2"></td><td colspan="2">H. Recognizes the role of commentary in providing additional levels of understanding.</td><td colspan="4">H. Recognizes that there can be more than one understanding to explain the text and quotes the מחז"ל “שבעים פנים לתורה.”[8]</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3"></td><td colspan="3">I. Differentiates between דרש and פשט.</td><td colspan="2">I. Differentiates between פשט, רמז, דרש and סוד.</td></tr>
</table>

[6] 'קיצור שלחן ערוך, סימן כ"ח, סעיף ד', ט

[7] See תניא, פרק ה', which explains the מעלה of the מצוה of learning תורה.

[8] A more rigorous level of understanding stems from the related מחז"ל, "אלו ואלו דברי א-לקים חיים", indicating that multiple explanations are correct. See the Appendix on this standard for further elaboration of these concepts.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
	J. Recognizes that we need תורה שבעל פה (as cited by commentaries on חומש) to assist in understanding the פסוק.						
K. Knows that the תורה was given through משה רבינו at הר סיני.		K. Knows that תורה שבעל פה was given with the תורה שבכתב to משה רבינו at הר סיני.		K. Explains that תורה שבעל פה employs specific rules of interpretation and cites and explains the examples of קל וחומר and גזירת שוה.			
				L. Quotes the מחז"ל, "הפך בה והפך בה דכולא בה," and explains that, therefore, תורה has a say about any issue in our lives and in the world around us (citing examples from the text being learned[9]).			
1.02 תורה מלשון הוראה							
A. Recognizes that there is a lesson to be learned from every topic in חומש.		A. When a lesson has been learned, thinks of ways that the lesson applies in their personal life.					
		B. Understands that the word תורה is related to הוראה, indicating that the primary purpose of תורה is to teach us lessons for our lives.		B. Expects personal relevance and lessons in עבודת ה' in every topic in חומש[10].			
	C. Sees the אבות and their conduct as examples for us and our lives.	C. Sees the accomplishments of the אבות as something which was passed down in our "spiritual DNA," enabling us to achieve similar things.		C. Sees comparisons between situations in the lives of our אבות and events in our nation's history and our personal lives.			

[9] Such as the fact that all animals in existence that either split hooves or chew their cuds are listed in פרשת שמיני.

[10] According to the Chassidic interpretation of the words "זאת התורה אדם" in במדבר, י"ט:י"ד.

Conventions תנ"ך

The student will be able to demonstrate an understanding of the conventions used in the letters, words and organization of a ספר תורה and how this affects the study of חומש.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. חומש conventions are part of the מסורה from סיני and preserve its integrity.	1. Why is it hard to learn from a ספר תורה? / Do we need punctuation? / Where do all the symbols and markings in חומש that I don't see in the ספר תורה come from?
2. The חומש conventions are precise and significant, and the basis for many important לימודים.	2. Why is the חומש text so "busy"? / Why are there so many dots, symbols and confusing letters in the חומש?
	3. How does the language of the תורה and the way it is written reflect the nature and purpose of the תורה?

Note to Teachers:

- *The Conventions Appendix is referenced throughout this standard, with the number for each particular convention.*
- *The scope and sequence for this standard is suggested, but if a particular convention comes up in the חומש earlier, it can be taught then.*
- *Conventions which appear in the Appendix but are not scoped below should be taught when they come up in the חומש.*

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.03 לשון התורה							
A. Knows that the Torah is written בלשון קודש – ה'ה's Holy Language with which ה' created the World.							
	B. Recognizes that the Torah speaks בלשון נקי' and will often use more words to say something in a nicer way e.g איננו טהור instead of טמא.			B. Knows that לשון נקי' is one example of תיקון סופרים, changes in the way the something is written in the תורה in order to teach us something and can name some other examples as well.			

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.03 לשון התורה							
	C. Recognizes that דברה תורה בלשון בני אדם – the Torah is written in a way that Man can understand, but it not literal when speaking about Hashem. E.g. Hashem has no Hand. (This is anthropomorphic language.)						
1.04 כתב, אותיות וניקוד							
A. Identifies that there is a unique script in the ספר תורה which is only used for סת"ם. (#10 in Appendix), and that there are sometimes unusually sized letters: אותיות רבתי וזעירי (#9 in Appendix).	A. Identifies that כתב אשורית is the unique script that is only used for סת"ם, and that there are unique features connected to the כתב in a ספר תורה that have significance.[11]						
B. Recognizes that although there are no נקודות under the words in the ספר תורה, (as it is indicated by the נקודות in חומש) is part of the מסורה. (#4 in Appendix.)							
C. Recognizes that at times the same words can be written differently in the Torah, with or without the אִמות הקריאה (אהוי) and this is called כתיב מלא or כתיב חסר and lessons can be learnt from these variations.							
		D. Recognizes that there are times when a word is written one way (כתיב) , but we are meant to pronounce it another way (קרי) and this is call קרי וכתיב and is part of מסורה.		D. Recognizes that the קרי וכתיב which is part of מסורה hints to varying messages and can begin to suggest the differences in the meanings of the קרי וכתיב in learned פסוקים.		D. Recognizes that the קרי וכתיב which is part of מסורה hints to varying messages and can begin to suggest the differences in the meanings of the קרי וכתיב in unlearned פסוקים.	

[11] אותיות רבתי-זעירי, נ הפוכה, ניקוד מעל האותיות, אותיות תלויות, כתרים (See items 9, 10 and 11 in Appendix).

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.05 טעמי המקרא							
A. Recognizes that although there is no punctuation in a ספר תורה, the טעמי המקרא that we see in the חומש, which indicate both the punctuation and the tune, are part of the מסורה. (#5 in Appendix)		A. Recognizes that although there is no punctuation in a ספר תורה, the טעמי המקרא that we see in the חומש, which indicate the punctuation, pronunciation (הברה) and the tune, are part of the מסורה. (#5 in Appendix)					
1.06 חלוקה לסדרות, פרשיות, פרקים							
A. Knows that the תורה is divided by חז"ל into סדרות (פרשיות השבוע)(#1), and that the תורה is also divided into פרקים (#3 in Appendix).		A. Knows that the סדרות (פרשיות השבוע) are from חז"ל, but the פרקים come from when the Torah was translated and is not from Jewish sources.					
		B. Distinguishes between a פרשה פתוחה and פרשה סתומה and understands their function. (#2 in Appendix)		B. Uses the division of פרשיות פתוחות and סתומות to divide the text into ענינים (rather than only using פרקים for topic division). (#2 in Appendix)			

Text Referencing Skills

The student will be able to demonstrate the skills and knowledge to be able to navigate the חומש.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. Every text has its own structure and "key" which enables us to navigate it.	1. How is this text structured?
2. It is necessary to know the structure of any text in order to be able to navigate and learn it effectively.	2. How does the structure of this text reflect its purpose and function?
3. The holiness and meaning conveyed by letters relates to their shapes, functions, and numerical values.	3. How is the א-ב different from any other alphabet?

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.07 Numerical Value of Letters[12]							
A. Provides the numerical value for the letters א through כ.	A. Provides the numerical value for the letters א through צט.	A. Provides the numerical value for the letters א through תצ"ט.		A. Provides the numerical value for the letters א through תת"ר.			
B. Provides the Hebrew letter for the numbers 1 through 20.	B. Provides the Hebrew letter for the numbers 1 through 99.	B. Provides the Hebrew letter for the numbers 1 through 499.		B. Provides the Hebrew letters for the numbers 1 through 1000.			
			C. Calculates the numerical value of words.	C. Calculates the numerical value of phrases (more than one word).			

[12] While a limited range of גמטריא is needed in order to navigate the חומש, this standard includes the full range of גמטריא skills that become relevant when learning רש"י and מפרשים, in order to keep all of these related skills in one place in the standards.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
1.08 The Five חומשים							
A. Recites the five חומשים in their correct sequence.				A. Recites the five חומשים in the correct sequence using standard and alternate names[13].			
		B. Writes the names of the five חומשים in sequence, and with proper spelling.		B. Writes the standard and alternate names of the five חומשים in sequence and with the proper spelling.			
		C. States the main theme of חומש בראשית and can give some examples to support the theme.		C. States the main theme in each of the five חומשים using the alternate names as clues, and can give some example from each חומש to support the theme.			
1.09 The Names of the סדרות/פרשיות							
A. Recites the פרשיות/סדרות in ספר בראשית in the correct sequence.	A. Recites the פרשיות/סדרות in ספר בראשית and שמות in the correct sequence.	A. Recites the פרשיות/סדרות in ספר בראשית, שמות and ויקרא in the correct sequence.	A. Recites the פרשיות/סדרות in all five חומשים in the correct sequence.	A. States the פרשה/סדרה before and after any given פרשה/סדרה.			
B. States which פרשיות/סדרות are found in ספר בראשית.	B. States which פרשיות/סדרות are found in ספר בראשית and שמות.	B. States which פרשיות/סדרות are found in ספר בראשית, שמות and ויקרא.	B. Matches each פרשה/סדרה to the חומש in which it belongs.				
		C. Writes the פרשיות/סדרות in ספר בראשית, שמות and ויקרא in the correct sequence.	C. Writes the פרשיות/סדרות in all five חומשים in the correct sequence, and with proper spelling.				

[13] ספר יצירה, ספר גאולה, תורת כהנים, ספר פקודים, משנה תורה

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
		D. States the content of the פרשיות/סדרות in חומש בראשית, using the names of the פרשיות/סדרות as clues.		D. States the content of the פרשיות/סדרות in חומש בראשית ושמות, using knowledge of main content areas, as well as the names of the פרשיות/סדרות as clues.		D. States the content of the פרשיות/סדורת in all five חומשים, using knowledge of main content areas, as well as the names of the פרשיות/סדרות as clues.	
1.10 Navigating the חומש							
A. Identifies the beginning and the end of a: ספר, פרשה/סדרה, פרק, and פסוק.	A. Identifies and *locates* a: ספר, פרשה/סדרה, פרק, and פסוק in בראשית and שמות.	A. Identifies and locates a: ספר, פרשה/סדרה, פרק, and פסוק in בראשית, שמות and ויקרא.	A. Identifies and locates a: ספר, פרשת השבוע/סדרה, פרק, and פסוק in all five חומשים.				
		B. Can sequence ראשון, שני... שביעי, and locates עליות in the פרשת השבוע/סדרה.					
		C. Locates the פרשיות פתוחות and פרשיות סתומות in the פרשת השבוע/סדרה.					
		D. Locates a רש"י with its דיבור המתחיל.				D. Locates any additional מפרשים used regularly in the class	
		E. Locates a פסוק in אונקלוס.		E. Locates a word in תרגום which has been referenced by רש"י.			

2. Content

A major part of the goal of learning חומש, in addition to fulfilling the obligation of לימוד תורה, is to learn its content: the history, life lessons, personalities, and instructions which are our national heritage. Although schools may differ in their particular syllabus choices as to which פרשיות or פרקים to cover, students in grades 1 through 6 can amass a large and valuable base of Torah knowledge. The essence of the Mitzvah of learning Torah is mastery of its content – ה's communication to the Jewish people.

Note to teachers: This standard provides an opportunity for students who struggle with other areas of learning חומש to shine. While engaging successfully with the text and language of חומש can prove challenging for many students, those same students may excel in engaging with the content learned from the חומש, independent of the text it is derived from.

Also note that the standards do not dictate a school's choice of syllabus and which content is covered. For suggested content items in ספר בראשית, see the Appendix to Standard 2.

Enduring Understandings	**Essential Questions**
1. The greater one's knowledge base of תורה content, the more confidently and readily one can access new topics and texts within תורה.	1. Why do I have to know this? 2. How can I remember this?
2. Knowledge and retention are the keys to be able to analyze, delve into and think deeply about תורה.	
3. Every detail in the תורה is equally holy and important, and selection of particular content is a purely pragmatic decision (based on time constraints and the role of the content in being able to access future topics and texts).	

Concrete Knowledge

The student will be able to demonstrate knowledge and retention of people, places, events/narratives, and select quotations.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
2.01 People							
A. Knows the names and basic profiles (i.e. main characteristics provided in the text being learned) of the main characters in the text being learned.			A. Knows the names and profiles of the main characters being learned, including details provided by sources other than the חומש text (רש"י, מדרשים, מפרשים), and retains names and profiles from previous grades.			A. Constructs personality profiles of main characters in the text being learned, based on the חומש text and relevant מפרשים being learned,[14] and retains names and profiles from previous grades.	
B. Knows the names of secondary characters who interact significantly with main characters, and the roles that they play.			B. Knows the names and roles of a greater range of secondary characters (but not all), focusing on those who play a greater role in the main narrative of the חומש being learned, and retains knowledge of secondary characters from previous grades.			B. Knows the names and roles of most of the characters that appear in the חומש text and relevant מפרשים being learned, and retains knowledge of secondary characters from previous grades.	
C. Identifies family relationships between main characters in the חומש being learned.	C. Draws a family tree of main characters in the חומש being learned.		C. Draws a family tree showing relationships among main and secondary characters in the חומש being learned, including family trees from previous grades.			C. Draws a family tree showing relationships among main and secondary characters in the חומש text and relevant מפרשים being learned, including family trees from previous grades.	

[14] See Standard 4.08.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
2.02 Places							
A. Knows the main places, referring to lands or nations, which are important to the story being learned (e.g. ארץ ישראל-, מצרים, ארץ פלישתים), and what took place in each.			A. Knows main places, referring to lands or nations, and more specific locations, i.e. cities, which are important to the story being learned (e.g. חברון, גרר, סוכות), and what took place in each, and retains knowledge of places from previous grades.				
	B. Finds locations and traces routes on a map.			B. Can place major locations and trace significant routes on a map (i.e. ארץ ישראל-ל and מצרים, מדבר סיני, the ירדן).			
2.03 Events / Narratives							
A. Knows the storyline (main events) of clearly cohesive stories learned in Chumash.	A. Knows the main events and significant details of the narrative that they are learning, and retains knowledge of storylines from previous grades.		A. Knows the broader storyline of multiple, connected stories in the Chumash that they are learning, and retains knowledge of storylines from previous grades.				
2.04 Quotations - לשונות							
A. Recognizes and understands select key לשונות and expressions from the פסוקים and content being learned.	A. Recalls and recites select key לשונות and expressions from פסוקים and content learned, and retains knowledge of quotations from previous grades.		A. Recalls and recites key לשונות, expressions, and important quotations from פסוקים and content learned, and retains knowledge of quotations from previous grades.				

Conceptual Knowledge

The student will be able to demonstrate knowledge and retention of terms, concepts, life lessons and מצוות.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
2.05 Terms and Concepts							
A. Knows and understands key terms and concepts in the פסוקים and content being learned, and retains knowledge of key terms and concepts from previous grades.							
B. Knows and understands the major lessons of the חומש narratives being learned, and retains knowledge of lessons learned in previous grades.							
2.06 מצוות							
A. Is familiar with מצוות that appear in the text.	A. Is familiar with מצוות that appear in the text, along with the details provided by the text.			A. Is familiar with מצוות that appear in the text, along with broader, basic details not provided by the חומש text (but by the teacher or other source).			
		B. Can relate a מצוה learned to its source/context in the חומש. [15]		B. Can relate a מצוה to its source in the חומש text, i.e., the specific לשון הפסוק.			

[15] E.g. "We first learn about the מצוה of ברית מילה when ה' commanded אברהם to have a ברית at 99 years old. "

3. Vocabulary and Language Skills

The language of חומש is לשון הקודש, the G-dly language with which ה' created the world. This language is precise, and all of its details have tremendous and untranslatable significance. Additionally, any translation of תורה is by definition already interpretive, since no two languages are identical. Therefore, the ability to understand the original text of חומש is essential to be able to learn its intended meaning, as well as to be able to relate to and appreciate the commentary and scholarship that surrounds the חומש and hinges on its textual details.

Vocabulary

The student will build a working vocabulary of common שרשים, שמות עצם, and other frequently used words in the חומש.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. Any translation of לשון הקודש is already interpretive, and therefore the full meaning of the תורה can only be accessed in its original language.	1. Why do I need to learn לשון הקדש?
2. No two languages are identical, and therefore many words in לשון הקודש will not have one exact translation in English which conveys its full, multifaceted meaning.	2. What is the best way to translate this word in this context?
3. A student must know 90% of words in a text to be able to independently study that text. [Knowledge of less than 75% of the words in the text is "frustration level – un-teachable."] [16]	3. Is it important to know every single word in a given text before approaching it?
4. In לשון הקדוש, the שורש or שם עצם is the foundation of almost every word in חומש, and learning a large number of these roots and basic words gives us access to most of the words that will appear in all of חומש.[17]	4. What is the שורש/שם עצם of this word?
5. Words in לשון הקדוש are interrelated, so learning vocabulary words gives a student access to a much greater number of as of yet unfamiliar but related words.	5. How is this word related or similar to a word that you have already learned?

[16] Gunning, 1998. Assessing and correcting reading and writing difficulty.
[17] See the Appendix to this standard for relevant studies and word lists.

Key Knowledge:

1. There are many rules in לשון הקודש and for every rule, there are always exceptions.
2. A noun in Hebrew is called a שם עצם. The word שם עצם refers to the singular version of that noun, and is considered the base word for all related forms of that noun. (E.g. משפחה is the שם עצם. Related forms include משפחות, למפשחותיהם, משפחתי, etc.)
3. A שורש can refer to the root of any word in לשון קודש. For the purposes of these standards, and for clarity for elementary school students, the term שורש will be used only for verbs. This שורש is comprised of 3 letters that should be presented with periods/full stops between each letter, and cannot be pronounced.
4. When a שורש appears in the verb, sometimes the 3 letters do not appear consecutively, or some of the letters of the שורש may not appear in the verb at all.
5. A verb in Hebrew is called a פועל. Every פועל has a שורש as its root. When a שורש is conjugated into various forms (בנינים, tense, etc. – see Verbs in Parts of Speech below), and given נקודות, it becomes a פועל (which can then be pronounced).
6. When referring to the letters of a שורש, the first letter is called the פ' הפועל, the second letter of the שורש is referred to as the ע' הפועל and the last letter is referred to as the ל' הפועל. These are often abbreviated to פה"פ, עה"פ, לה"פ
7. There are unique שורשים that are considered "weak שורשים" and they often lose letters or have different ניקוד than other שורשים in the same בנין. We refer to this unique שורשים by their weak letter. For example שורשים that are in the category of ע"ו mean שורשים where the ע' הפועל is the letter vav, such as ק.ו.מ. Other categories include פ"נ, פ"י,פ"א, ע"י, ל"ה,ל"א
8. Some words, depending on how they are used, can function as nouns, verbs, or adjectives. (E.g. קטן can be both a noun and adjective, and can be conjugated as a verb such as קטונתי. The word שופט is a noun, adjective and verb.)
9. In these standards, all words are divided into three categories: nouns, שורשים for verbs and "other words". These other words include numbers, pronouns, prepositions and conjunctions.

Note to Teachers: Explicit, direct instruction strategies for vocabulary include the introduction of new words, including definitions, and the use of concrete examples whenever possible. Students should be given the opportunity to use the words in context rather than in isolation. Oral vocabulary activities and games can make vocabulary learning a more enjoyable experience.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.01 Vocabulary: שמות עצם (nouns)							
A. States the meaning of 25 שמות עצם.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 25 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 50.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 50 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 75.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 75 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 100.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 100 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 125	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 125 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 150.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 150 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 175.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 175 previously learned שמות עצם, equaling a total of 200.
B. Provides the correct שם עצם from A when given its English translation.							
C. Identifies and groups nouns in the חומש that share the same שם עצם, learned in A.							
D. Identifies and translates previously learned שמות עצם in an unlearned פסוק when prompted by the teacher.				D. Identifies and translates previously learned שמות עצם in an unlearned פסוק.			
E. States multiple translations of a single word, when those translations have been learned in the פסוקים. (i.e. רוח – wind, spirit)		E. For words with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a given word based on its context, when the rest of the פסוק has been taught. (ראש, רוח)			E. For words with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a given word based on its context, in an unlearned פסוק. (ראש, רוח)		
3.02 Vocabulary: שורשים (for verbs)							
A. States the meaning of 15 שורשים when shown the שורש.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 15 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 40.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 40 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 65.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 65 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 90.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 90 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 115.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 115 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 140.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 140 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 165.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 165 previously learned שורשים, equaling a total of 190.
B. Provides the correct שורש from A when given its meaning in English.							

<table>
<tr><th>Level 1</th><th>Level 2</th><th>Level 3</th><th>Level 4</th><th>Level 5</th><th>Level 6</th><th>Level 7</th><th>Level 8</th></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">C. Identifies the שורש in the חומש, from שורשים learned in A, when all three letters of the שורש appear consecutively in the word, from שורשים learned in A.</td><td>C. Identifies the 4 letters which are commonly left out (יונה),[18] and identifies the שורש in the חומש, from שורשים learned in A, when two or three letters of the שורש appear consecutively in the word.</td><td>C. Identifies the 4 letters which are commonly left out (יונה), and identifies the שורש in the חומש, from שורשים learned in A, when the middle letter of the שורש is missing (the two remaining letters are not consecutive in the שורש).</td><td colspan="2">C. Identifies the 4 letters which are commonly left out (יונה), and identifies the שורש in the חומש, from שורשים learned in A, including the following variations: 3 letters with a י between them (ממליך), 2 letters with a י between them (הגיד), and when the first letter of the שורש is a י and is replaced by a ו (הוליד, הוריד, הוסיף).[19]</td><td colspan="2">C. Identifies all שרשים in learned חומש, including both שלמים and חסרים.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="8">D. Identifies and groups verbs (and adjectives[20]) in the חומש that share the same שורש, from שורשים learned in A.</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td colspan="3">E. Identifies and translates previously learned שורשים in an unlearned פסוק when prompted by the teacher.</td><td colspan="3">E. Identifies and translates previously learned שורשים in an unlearned פסוק.</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td colspan="2">F. States multiple translations of a single שורש, when those translations have been learned in the פסוקים.[21]</td><td colspan="2">F. For שורשים with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a given word based on its context,</td><td colspan="2">F. For שורשים with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a</td></tr>
</table>

[18] These 4 letters are indicated by the mnemonic יונה פרח. A fifth letter, ל, is dropped only from the שורש, לקח.

[19] These variations should be taught when they appear in the text being learned.

[20] Verbs and adjectives are grouped together here, because they often function in similar ways. Adjectives are conjugated in the same way as verbs in הווה, in בנין קל. (E.g גדול, גדולה, גדולים, גדולות.)

[21] E.g. the word וירא in ב, בראשית י"ח

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
				when the rest of the פסוק has been taught. [22]		given word based on its context, in an unlearned פסוק.	
3.03 [23]Other Vocabulary: prepositions and conjunctions (connecting words)[24] and other vocabulary (adverbs, numbers, questioning words, etc.)							
A. States the meaning of 25 of these words.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 25 previously learned words, equaling a total of 50.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 50 previously learned words, equaling a total of 75.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 75 previously learned words, equaling a total of 100.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 100 previously learned words, equaling a total of 125.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 125 previously learned words, equaling a total of 150.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 150 previously learned words, equaling a total of 175.	A. States the meaning of 25 new and 175 previously learned words, equaling a total of 200.
B. Provides the correct Hebrew word from A when given its English translation.							
		C. For words with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a given word based on its context, when the rest of the פסוק has been taught. (כי, את, עוד,על)			C. For words with multiple translations, can choose the appropriate translation for a given word based on its context, in an unlearned פסוק. (כי,את, עוד, על)		

[22] For example, רש"י on ויגדל - שמות, פרק ב, פסוק י,י"א.

[23] For younger grades especially, these words do not have to be categorized but should be presented as anything that is not a noun or verb – i.e. "other vocabulary words." These words should be taught as the text requires, and therefore the teacher might teach less or more words than indicated here.

[24] These usually answer the questions where and when, such as:אז,אצל, אחר, על

Parts of Speech

The student will be able to identify and differentiate between parts of speech, and apply this knowledge to translate phrases in the חומש.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. As a G-dly language, לשון הקודש is both precise and concise, using grammar to incorporate information about a word in the word itself.	1. How many words would be required in English to give the full meaning of this Hebrew word?
2. Words serve different functions and are divided accordingly into parts of speech.	2. What kind of word is this?
3. In לשון הקודש, individual letters themselves, (as well as נקודות,) often have meanings and functions. (relevant to prefixes and suffixes)	3. What is the function of this letter? (relevant to prefixes and suffixes)

Key Knowledge:

- Nouns and verbs/adjectives are conjugated differently from one another in לשון הקדש. (Prefixes and suffixes change depending on whether the word is a noun or verb/adjective.)

Key Knowledge: (for 3.04 Nouns and Adjectives)

1. Nouns are words which refer to people, places and things.
2. Nouns in לשון הקודש have gender and number embedded in the way they are written.
3. Adjectives are words that describe nouns. In Hebrew, an adjective is called a שם תואר.
4. Adjectives in לשון הקודש have gender and number embedded in the way they are written, and must match the gender and number of the noun that it is describing.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.04 Nouns and Adjectives (naming words, describing words)							
A. Identifies nouns from a group of learned words, and gives examples of nouns in English.		A. Identifies nouns in a learned פסוק.		A. Identifies nouns in an unlearned פסוק (based on the way it appears in the פסוק – its prefixes, suffixes, and form of the word).		A. Identifies nouns in an unlearned פסוק, including nouns that are related to and look like verbs or adjectives.[25]	

[25] Some examples: שופט, מפשט, מצוה, שופטים ושוטרים, שומר

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
	B. Distinguishes between זכר and נקבה nouns, in a group of learned words. (בקר, יום / לבנה, בהמה)	B. Distinguishes between זכר and נקבה nouns in the חומש, including common יוצאים מן הכלל in the חומש: words that appear to be זכר but are really נקבה[26], or appear to be נקבה but are really זכר[27], or words that can be either זכר or נקבה[28]					
	C. Distinguishes between singular and plural nouns (with –ות or –ים endings) in a group of learned words.	C. Distinguishes between singular and plural nouns (with –ות or –ים endings) in the חומש, including words that end with רבים endings in לה"ק but are not plural in English (מים, פנים) and including common יוצאים מן הכלל in the חומש: words that are זכר but which receive –ות when in plural, (אבות, קרבנות), and words that are נקבה but receive –ים when in plural (שנה-שנים).					
	D. Identifies adjectives from a group of learned words, and give examples of adjectives in both לשון הקודש (from learned words) and English.	D. Identifies adjectives in a learned פסוק.		D. Identifies adjectives in an unlearned פסוק (based on the way it appears in the פסוק – its prefixes, suffixes, and form of the word - and on context[29]).			

[26] Body parts that come in pairs –e.g. ידים/יד, עינים/עין – and words relating to land and location – e.g. ארץ, מקום, עיר

[27] בית, לילה

[28] מחנה, שמש, רוח, אש See list in רש"י on "המחנה האחת והכהו", פרק ל"ב, פסוק ט', בראשית.

[29] Context is essential with adjectives since they are often identical to nouns and verbs.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
	E. Matches nouns and adjectives from a group of learned words based on gender and number.	E. Matches nouns and adjectives in a learned פסוק based on gender and number.		E. Matches nouns and adjectives in an unlearned פסוק based on gender and number.		E. Matches nouns and adjectives in an unlearned פסוק based on gender and number, and identifies common יוצאים מן הכלל in the חומש, matching nouns and adjectives which would not otherwise appear to go together (יד חזקה).	
		F. Recognizes סמיכות – when one noun comes after the other, with the second noun being a definite noun, and describing or qualifying the first, and the word של is missing – when it has been pointed out by the teacher.[30]	F. Recognizes סמיכות – when one noun comes after the other, with the second noun being either definite or indefinite, and qualifies the first with word של missing.	F. Identifies סמיכות by context, and letter changes in the first word of the pair (when there is a –ים or קמץ ה ending).[31]		F. Identifies סמיכות by context, changes in the אותיות, changes in ניקוד[32], and טעמי המקרא.	

[30] E.g. בני ישרא-ל, תולדות נח, רוח א-לקים, פתח האהל, עבד אברהם, עבד עברי. The teacher can illustrate the changes in אותיות and/or ניקוד but this is not necessary until later grades.
[31] E.g. בני ישרא-ל, זעקת סדום
[32] E.g. דָּבָר ה' instead of דָּבַר ה'

Key Knowledge: (for 3.05 Pronouns)

1. A pronoun is a word that takes the place of a noun.
2. Nouns can serve as either a subject or object: who or what is doing the action is the subject, and who or what is receiving the action is the object.
3. Different kinds of pronouns replace nouns, depending on whether they are the subject or object. (For example, אני refers to a subject and is a *subjective* pronoun, and אותי refers to an object and is an *objective* pronoun, just like in English, "I" refers to a subject, and "me" refers to an object.)
4. Pronouns also appear in other forms depending on how they are used in the sentence. For example, there are *demonstrative* pronouns to point something out (e.g. this, those - זאת ,זה...), *interrogative* pronouns to ask questions (e.g. who, what, etc. - מי, מה), and *prepositional* pronouns to describe relationships in time and place (e.g. with, to, etc. - אלי, אתי, עמי, ממני).
5. For every pronoun, we need to figure out who or what it is talking about. This is the pronoun's *referent* (what the pronoun *refers* to). Pronouns match their *referent* nouns in gender and number.
6. There is no such thing as "it" in לה"ק. Since all nouns, not only people, are either זכר or נקבה, the pronouns that replace them are always זכר or נקבה as well.
7. In לה"ק, pronouns are often indicated by prefixes and suffixes attached to other words, instead of being written separately.

Note to Teachers: The first standard for each kind of pronoun is the ability to use that kind of pronoun in English. This standard should be taught as a fundamental, introductory unit to pronouns, in which the teacher points out to students how pronouns are used and their different varieties, and students have the opportunity to use them in a class discussion or exercise. The English pronouns themselves may not be new to first graders, but this הקדמה *will make them more aware of the kinds of pronouns we use and the roles that they play.*

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.05 Pronouns							
A. Substitutes subjective nouns with pronouns, and identifies to what or to whom the pronouns refer, in English[33]; and states the subjective pronouns in לשון הקודש[34], and translates them from לה"ק to English and vice versa.	A. States the referent of a subjective pronoun in a learned פסוק, whether the pronoun is written separately in the פסוק or embedded in the word.[35]	A. State the referent of a subjective pronoun in a learned פסוק, even when the referent is in a different learned פסוק.		A. States the referent of a subjective pronoun in learned or unlearned פסוקים, whether the pronoun is written separately in the פסוק or embedded in the word.			
		B. Distinguishes between first, second and third person pronouns (גוף ראשון, גוף שני, גוף שלישי...).					

[33] I, you, he, she, we, they

[34] אני, אתה, את, הוא, היא, אתם, אתן, הם, הן

[35] E.g. ויהי מבדיל – הרקיע. ויתן אותם – ה', המאורות

<table>
<tr><th>Level 1</th><th>Level 2</th><th>Level 3</th><th>Level 4</th><th>Level 5</th><th>Level 6</th><th>Level 7</th><th>Level 8</th></tr>
<tr><td>C. Substitutes possessive nouns with pronouns, and identifies to what or to whom the pronouns refer, in English (my, mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs).</td><td>C. States the possessive pronouns in לשון הקודש and translates them (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) – שלי, שלך...</td><td colspan="2">C. In learned פסוקים, identify possessive suffixes and state the pronouns and referents to which they refer.</td><td colspan="4">C. In unlearned פסוקים, identify possessive suffixes and state the pronouns and referents to which they refer.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">D. Substitutes objective nouns with pronouns, and identifies to what or to whom the pronouns refer, in English (me, him, her, us, them).</td><td>D. States the objective pronouns in לה"ק - (אותי, אותך...) and can state the reference noun that they replace in learned פסוקים.[36]</td><td colspan="2">D. Identifies objective suffixes and states objective pronouns and the noun to which they refer in learned פסוקים.[37] (see also 3.05F and 3.07H)</td><td colspan="4">D. In unlearned פסוקים, identifies objective pronouns and suffixes, and the nouns to which they refer.</td></tr>
</table>

[36] For example, in the פסוק that states "ויוסיפו עוד שנא אותו" (בראשית, ל"ז:ח) , the objective pronoun אותו refers to יוסף.

[37] For example, ויקחהו is ויקח אותו.

<table>
<tr><th>Level 1</th><th>Level 2</th><th>Level 3</th><th>Level 4</th><th>Level 5</th><th>Level 6</th><th>Level 7</th><th>Level 8</th></tr>
<tr><td colspan="4">E. Uses demonstrative pronouns appropriately as a substitute for “a,” in English (this, that, these).</td><td>E. States the demonstrative pronouns in לה"ק and translates them (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) (זה, זאת, אלה, אלו...)</td><td>E. Identifies demonstrative pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in learned פסוקים.</td><td colspan="2">E. Identifies demonstrative pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in unlearned פסוקים.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3"></td><td>F. Recognizes that objective pronouns can be attached to prepositions as suffixes, and identifies to which pronouns these suffixes refer. (e.g. לי, אלי, ממני, אתי, עלי...)</td><td>F. Identifies prepositions with objective pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in learned פסוקים.</td><td colspan="3">F. Identifies prepositions with objective pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in unlearned פסוקים.</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td>G. Identifies the prefixes איתן and the pronouns to which they refer, in learned פסוקים.</td><td colspan="2">G. Identifies the suffixes תהימון and the prefixes איתן and the pronouns to which they refer, in learned פסוקים.</td><td colspan="3">G. Uses the prefixes איתן and the suffixes תהימון to aid in the independent translation of חומש words.</td></tr>
</table>

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
H. Uses interrogative pronouns – questions to which the answer is a noun/pronoun - in English, and responds to interrogative pronouns by providing the correct nouns. (e.g. who, to whom, whose, what, which…)	H. Translates the interrogative pronouns in לה"ק, and responds correctly to questions that begin with them. (e.g. מי, מה, למי)	H. Responds to questions beginning with the לה"ק interrogative pronouns answering using the correct referent noun from the פסוקים (e.g איזוהי, מיהו).		H. Responds to questions beginning with the לה"ק interrogative pronouns answering using the correct referent noun, or as indicated by the pronouns in both learned and unlearned פסוקים.			
				I. States the interrogative pronouns in לה"ק and translates them (from לה"ק to English and vice versa מי, מה, איזו, איזה וכו')	I. Identifies interrogative pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in learned פסוקים.		I. Identifies interrogative pronouns and the nouns to which they refer in unlearned פסוקים.

Key Knowledge: (for 3.06 Prepositions, Conjunctions and the Definite Article)

1. A preposition is a word that indicates the relationship between two things in time and place (or other relationships), e.g. *on, with, over, under, before, after*, *from, to, in, like* etc.
2. A conjunction combines two words – i.e. *and*.
3. In English, the word "a" is called an *indefinite article*, and the word "the" is called a *definite article*, as it refers to something specific. In לה"ק, we do not have the indefinite article - "a." The letter ה serves as the definite article – "the."
4. The word את either means "with" or is untranslatable. The untranslatable את acts like an arrow, pointing to the direct object that receives the action in the פסוק. This kind of את always comes before a definite noun (a noun with a definite article, a possessive noun, or a proper noun). E.g. "בראשית ברא א-לקים את השמים..."
5. The two meanings of את can be recognized from two common groups of words that students are familiar with. את as "with" is the basis for the words אתי, אתך etc., which mean with me, with you…. (Standard 3.05 F). את as a direct object marker is the basis for the words אותי, אותך etc. – the objective pronouns (3.05 D).

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.06 Prepositions, Conjunctions and the Definite Article							
A. Translates (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) the conjunctive prefix ו (and), and identify it in a learned פסוק.[38]	A. Identifies and translates the conjunctive ו in learned פסוקים.	A. Identifies and translates the conjunctive ו in learned and unlearned פסוקים.		A. Identify the conjunctive ו by its ניקוד (to distinguish from other vavs, i.e. ו ההיפוך). (See Appendix.)		A. Identify the conjunctive ו in its various forms and explain the reasons for the change in ניקוד. (See Appendix.)	

[38] Not to be confused with ו ההיפוך – see Appendix for the rules that differentiate them.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
	B. Identifies ו ההיפוך attached to future tense, and its role in learned פסוקים.		B. Identifies ו ההיפוך attached to future tense, and uses it to translate those verbs correctly, in unlearned פסוקים.	B. Identifies ו ההיפוך attached to both future and past tense, and its role in learned פסוקים.		B. Identifies ו ההיפוך attached to both future and past tense in unlearned פסוקים and explains the reasons for the change in ניקוד.	
C. Translates (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) the ה הידיעה (definite article ה – the), and identifies it in a learned פסוק.	C. Identifies and translates the ה הידיעה in learned פסוקים.	C. Identifies and translates ה הידיעה in unlearned פסוקים, as well as ה השאלה when it appears, in learned פסוקים.	C. Identifies and translates ה הידיעה and ה השאלה in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	C. Identifies the ה הידיעה and ה השאלה in unlearned פסוקים by its distinctive ניקוד (see Appendix).		C. Identifies the ה הידיעה and ה השאלה by their distinctive ניקוד in unlearned פסוקים, and explains the reasons for the changes in ניקוד.	
	D. Identifies and translates the locative ה (ה המגמה) when it appears in learned פסוקים.[39]	D. Identifies and translates the locative ה (ה המגמה) in unlearned פסוקים.					

[39] וילך חרנה – אל חרן

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
E. Translates (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) the prepositional prefixes -ב-כ ל-מ, and identifies them in a learned פסוק.	E. Identifies and translates the prepositional prefixes -ב-כ ל-מ in learned פסוקים. [40]	E. Identifies and translates the prepositional prefixes ב-כ-ל-מ in unlearned פסוקים, and identifies when the ה הידיעה is combined with the ב-כ-ל (not מ), based on ניקוד (see Appendix).				E. Identifies the prepositional prefixes ב-כ-ל-מ based on their distinctive ניקוד, and explains the variations in ניקוד (including the difference between מ and the other three). (See Appendix)	
F. [41]Translates (from לה"ק to English and vice versa) the prefix ש, and identifies that it stands for אשר.	F. Identifies and translates the prefix ש in learned texts.[41]	F. Identifies and translates the prefix ש in unlearned texts. [41]					
G. Identifies that the word את usually is not translatable.	G. Identifies that the word את means with or is not translatable, and can differentiate in learned פסוקים.			G. Identifies that the word את is either "with," or an untranslatable word that points to a direct object[42] that is a definite noun, and differentiates between its two meanings in unlearned פסוקים.			

[40] Note: Introduce other, less common, meanings of ב and כ as they appear.

[41] There is no prefix ש in חומש. However, this standard has been retained because the ש appears in the סידור, נ"ך and מפרשים, so knowing this letter is necessary for a complete mastery of לשון הקדש and the ability to learn מפרשי חומש and other sacred texts.

[42] See 3.05 D.

Key Knowledge: (for 3.07 Verbs)

1. Verbs in לשון הקודש have tense, person (גוף), gender and number embedded in the way they are written. (See Appendix for a chart of verb parsing.)
2. The ניקוד (and sometimes added letters) of the verb gives us information about it.
3. There are patterns of how to conjugate a verb, called בנינים, which alter the meaning of a שורש. (There is no parallel in English.)
4. The בנינים are divided into 4 categories: simple, forceful, causative and reflexive. (Each of the first three has an active and passive form.) Identifying the unique pattern of ניקוד and אותיות of each בנין, gives us insight into the meaning of a word and helps us to translate it correctly.
5. The 4 active בנינים are: קל (simple), פיעל (forceful or sometimes causative), הפעיל (causative) and התפעל (reflexive). See the Appendix for the conjugation of each בנין.
6. The first three active בנינים each have a matching passive בנין: The three passive בנינים are נפעל (simple - partner of קל), פועל (forceful - partner of פיעל); הופעל (causative - partner of הפעיל)
7. Verbs also have tense or aspect. Tenses are עבר (past), הווה (present or participle), or עתיד (future). Verb forms can also be in ציווי (imperative) or in two types of infinitive forms, known as שם הפועל- regular infinitive (e.g. לשמור) and the infinitive absolute also known as the infinitive of emphasis (מקור).
8. Infinite absolute verbs are often found before a future tense verb with the same שורש. E.g שמוע תשמעו**,** מות תמות**.** They serve to emphasize the action and cause the translation 'surely', e.g. "You will surely die". The infinitive absolute can also be found on its own, indication ongoing action. E.g. הלוך ונסוע- "he was travelling on". Another example is שמור and זכור in the עשרת הדברות. See Rashi שמות כ:ח on the word זכור.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.07 Verbs							
A. Identifies verbs from a group of learned words, and gives examples of verbs in both לשון הקודש (from learned words) and English.	A. Identifies verbs in a learned פסוק.			A. Identifies verbs in an unlearned פסוק (based on their format).			
	B. Identifies that אותיות איתן before a verb indicate future tense [in any בנין], in learned פסוקים.[43]	B. Identifies verbs in future tense by the איתן prefixes, differentiates the pronouns by also looking for the accompanying suffix (ת-י, י-ו, ת-נה), and translates accordingly, in learned פסוקים.		B. Identifies verbs in future tense by the איתן prefixes and accompanying suffix when needed (ת-י, י-ו, ת-נה), and translates accordingly, in unlearned פסוקים.		B. Identifies verbs in future tense in all of the active בנינים, differentiates between them, and translates accordingly, in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
			C. Identifies that אותיות תהימון after a verb indicate past tense, in learned פסוקים. (See pronouns with regard to their translation.)		C. Identifies verbs in past tense by the suffixes תהימון, and translates accordingly, in unlearned פסוקים.	C. Identifies verbs in past tense in all of the active בנינים, differentiates between them, and translates accordingly, in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
			D. Identifies בנין קל verbs in הווה (the present tense) and their גוף, by their		D. Identifies בנין קל verbs in הווה (the present tense) and their	D. Identifies verbs in הווה in all of the active בנינים, differentiates between them, and translates accordingly, in	

[43] See pronouns with regard to their translation, and ההיפוך ו for how they are commonly used in חומש.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
			conjugation[44] in learned פסוקים.		גוף, by their conjugation[45] in unlearned פסוקים.	learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
			E. Identifies verbs in ציווי by their conjugation (look like future tense but are missing איתן prefix) in learned פסוקים.		E. Identifies verbs in ציווי by their conjugation (look like future tense but are missing איתן prefix) in unlearned פסוקים.	E. Identifies verbs in ציווי in all active בנינים, differentiate between them, and translates accordingly in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
				F. Identifies verbs in מקור and שם הפועל forms, in learned פסוקים.		F. Identifies verbs in מקור and שם הפועל forms in all of the active בנינים, differentiates between them, and translates accordingly, in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
				G. Identifies when learned verbs are passive as opposed to active.		G. Identifies verbs that are in the passive בנין of נפעל, in learned and unlearned פסוקים.	
			H. Identifies objective suffixes when attached to a verb (see 3.05 D) and translate the verb accordingly, in learned and unlearned פסוקים.				

44 Often but not always a חולם after the first letter of the שרש. However, this is not the case for all verbs of the ע"ו and ע"י category where the הווה form is different. E.g. בא, באה, קם, קמה, שב, שבה etc.

45 As above in previous footnote

Syntax (Sentence Structure)

The student will be able to construct the meaning of the פסוק based on analyzing its parts, including word combination, word order and dividing a פסוק into phrases.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. The sentence structure of לה"ק is different from the sentence structure of English.	1. How would this פסוק or phrase be written differently if it were in English?
2. תורה comes with a set of rules for punctuation and sentence structure in the form of טעמי המקרא, which are הלכה למשה מסיני.	2. What do the טעמי המקרא tell us about how to organize and understand this פסוק?
3. Just like words serve particular functions, such as nouns (naming words) and verbs (action words), different parts of a פסוק or sentence provide different kinds of information (subject, action, description, etc.)	3. What is this part of the פסוק doing/telling us?

Key Knowledge:

1. פסוקים in לה"ק cannot be translated word for word into English without changing the order of the words.
2. In order to translate the פסוקים into meaningful sentences, the words need to be grouped into two- and three-word units and translated for meaning rather than individually and literally. For example, ויאמר ה' אל משה means "Hashem said to Moshe," and not "He said Hashem to Moshe."
3. Nouns, verbs and adjectives are all conjugated differently from one another in לשון הקדש. (Prefixes and suffixes change depending on whether the word is a noun or verb.)
4. A פסוק may or may not be a complete sentence. (Some פסוקים are dependent clauses reliant on previous פסוקים).
5. A פסוק may contain one or more 'English' sentences.
6. The simplest Hebrew sentence comprises of a noun and a verb or an adjective.
7. The person doing the action or the person or item being described in a sentence is called the subject. "Who" is doing the action or "Who or what" is this talking about?
8. The person or thing that receives the action (verb) is the direct object of the sentence.

9. The indirect object identifies to whom or for whom, the action of the verb is performed. E.g: "ויעקב נתן לעשו לחם ונזיד עדשים". – Yaakov is the subject, the food (לחם ונזיד עדשים) is the object – Yaakov gave food; עשו is the indirect object – he is the one to whom the food was given.
10. The rest of the sentence will give us additional information like where, when, why or how something was done.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.08 Grouping and Word Order							
A. Groups the פסוק into phrases (of two or three words), when translating a learned פסוק.		A. Groups the פסוק into phrases (of two or three words), when translating a פסוק for which literal translation is provided but grouping into phrases is not.		A. Groups the פסוק into phrases when translating an unlearned פסוק, according to the rules of סמיכות (see nouns) and context.			
B. Changes word order appropriately when translating phrases in learned פסוקים.		B. Changes word order appropriately when translating a פסוק for which literal translation is provided but grouping into phrases is not, identifying when word order is different than in English.		B. Changes word order appropriately when translating an unlearned פסוק, identifying when word order is different than in English.			
3.09 Parsing the פסוק							
A. Identifies the אתנחתא and סוף פסוק, and their roles, and divides an unlearned פסוק into two parts accordingly.		A. Identifies the זקף קטן, זקף גדול, סגול, רביעי, and their roles, in addition to the אתנחתא and סוף פסוק, and their roles and reads, translates and punctuates the פסוק accordingly.		A. Identifies מרכא-טפחא, קדמא-אזלא and the תביר-טפחא as indicating words that should not be separated for translation, and reads, translates and punctuates the פסוק accordingly in addition to being able to divide the פסוק based on the טעמי המקרא learned in previous years.			

ניקוד and הברה

The student will be able to:

- explain the system of ניקוד used in תנ"ך.
- explain variations of ניקוד found in many areas of grammar and parts of speech.

Note to Teachers: This standard is for advanced students. Understanding ניקוד *together with the other language skills already mastered, gives students the skills needed to understand* רש"י *when he deals with* דקדוק *and to better understand other* מפרשים *which focus on* דקדוק.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. How we pronounce the words in the תורה was taught to us by משה רבינו and includes טעמי המקרא and נקודות.	1. Why should we learn these rules? / How will these rules help me?
2. The rules of ניקוד and הברה of לשון קודש and how they interact with the טעמי המקרא are evident today in our printed versions of תנ"ך.	2. Where do we see examples of this ניקוד rule in the תנ"ך?

Key Knowledge:

1. The common term נקודות actually incorporates a number of different items that all include dots.
2. נקודות that actually create distinct sounds are called תנועות. They allow one to move across the word.
3. תנועות are divided into two groups: תנועות גדולות and תנועות קטנות[46].
4. A syllable is called a הברה. You can only have one תנועה in any syllable.
5. שבאים are made of dots but they are not תנועות.
6. There are two types of שבאים, the שבא נע and the שבא נח, and they have distinct rules related to their purpose, placement and pronunciation[47].
7. Other 'dots' include דגשים, and the מפיק ה'.

[46] See Language Appendix for the differences between them.
[47] See Appendix

8. There are two types of דגשים, the דגש קל and דגש חזק, and they have distinct rules related to their purpose, placement and pronunciation.

Note to teachers: The key knowledge above is elaborated upon in the Appendices. There are many important details there that need to be mastered. Please refer to those supporting documents.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
3.10 Understanding ניקוד							
						A. Differentiates between the different types of תנועות and can explain their purpose and distinct rules.	
						B. Differentiates between the different types of שבאים and can explain their purpose and distinct rules.	
						C. Differentiates between the different types of דגשים and can explain their purpose and distinct rules.	
						D. Uses the rules of תנועות, שבאים and דגשים to divide any word in the חומש into its distinct syllables.	
						E. Identifies and explains how and when the טעמי המקרא affect the ניקוד of a word.	

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
						F. Use their knowledge of ניקוד to explain variations in ניקוד of grammatical items found in חומש.	
						G. Use their knowledge of דקדוק to explain both learned and unlearned commentaries that refer to or explain a דקדוק rule or variation found in חומש.	

4. Passage (פסוק) Comprehension Skills

Passage comprehension builds upon other Chumash skills, most significantly vocabulary and language skills, and requires students to transfer the information that they learn from the פסוקים into a coherent understanding of the subject matter.

The student will be able to:

- Find facts and quotes in one or more פסוקים.
- Use higher order thinking to analyze פסוקים.
- Demonstrate the ability to integrate knowledge and ideas.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. The חומש incorporates many different kinds of text styles, including narratives, quotations, instructions, lists and שירה (songs).	1. What is the style and function of this portion of the text? / What is the Torah doing here?
2. Recognizing the correct text style for a given passage is an important step to being able to extract key information from the texts.	2. How do the features of this particular text style help me find the information I need? / What clues should I be looking for?
3. A more holistic and comprehensive understanding and appreciation of the depth of the Torah text is only achieved through engaging with the original Hebrew text and language.	3. If I look more carefully, what else can I find- in this פסוק or in previous פסוקים?
	4. How does this פסוק relate to what I learned earlier? / Does this add to or contradict what I learned elsewhere?
4. Vocabulary and language skills are the crucial foundations for passage comprehension.	5. What skills/words do I need to learn to be able to do this?
5. The חומש employs literal, figurative and symbolic language.	6. What are the layers of meaning for this word/phrase/event?
6. There are multiple levels of understanding, from basic to rigorous.	7. How does this new פסוק or piece of information add to my greater understanding of this topic/person/theme?
7. Students need to be able to demonstrate comprehension in multiple ways before rigorous understanding is evident.	8. What else can I do to show that I understand this?

Finding Information

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
4.01 Finding Facts							
A. Retells the basic Who, What, When, Where, Why of the פסוק after it was taught by the teacher.	A. Answers Who, What, When, Where, Why questions when the פסוק was translated, but the teacher did not explain the "W's."	A. Answers Who, What, When, Where, Why questions in a group of פסוקים when the פסוקים were translated, but the teacher did not explain the "W's."	A. Uses language skills and context clues to answer the 5 W questions on an individual, unlearned פסוק.	A. Uses language skills and context clues to answer the 5 W questions when learning a number of new פסוקים independently.			
B. Refers explicitly to the language of the text as the basis for their answers - עונה בלשון המקרא.							
4.02 Finding Quotes							
A. Differentiates between the narrative and a quote within the narrative.	A. Differentiates between the narrative, a quote, and a quote within a quote.						

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
B. Identifies the beginning and the end of a quote that is found within one פסוק after the information was taught by the teacher.	B. Identifies the beginning and the end of a quote that is found within one פסוק. The פסוק is translated, but the student finds the quote independently (using key words that indicate speech for assistance).	B. Identifies the beginning and the end of a quote[48] in a group of פסוקים. The פסוקים have been translated, but the student finds the quote independently, using key words indicating speech for assistance.		B. Identifies the beginning and the end of a quote in a group of unlearned פסוקים.			

[48] Students can learn to look for these indicators of the end of a quote: when the פסוק changes from first or second person to third person, and by the טעמי המקרא.

Higher Order Thinking

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
4.03 Logical Sequencing							
A. Sequences events chronologically (in English) in one or two פסוקים when the פסוקים have been translated, and the sequence has been pointed out by the teacher.	A. Sequences events chronologically (in English) in a group of פסוקים when the פסוקים have been translated, but the sequence has not been pointed out by the teacher.	A. Sequences events chronologically (in לשון הפסוק) in a group of פסוקים when the פסוקים have been translated, but the sequence has not been pointed out by the teacher.		A. Sequences events chronologically (in לשון הפסוק) in a group of unlearned פסוקים (based on context clues or language skills).			
		B. Identifies and sequences cause and effect in a learned פסוק after the cause and effect has been pointed out by the teacher.	B. Identifies and sequences cause and effect in learned פסוקים where the cause and effect has not been pointed out by the teacher.	B. Identifies and sequences cause and effect in unlearned פסוקים (based on context clues, language skills, or key words related to cause and effect[49]).			

[49] E.g. למען, פן, כי etc.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
4.04 Comparing and Contrasting							
A. Compares and contrasts the actions or experiences of two individuals in a learned story or group of פסוקים, after the comparison was pointed out by the teacher.		A. Compares and contrasts similar personalities, events, and texts in the פסוקים after the פסוקים were translated but the comparison was not pointed out in the פסוקים. (See Appendix for items to compare and contrast, and how to do so.)		A. Compares and contrasts similar personalities, events and texts in learned פסוקים to unlearned פסוקים. (See Appendix for items to compare and contrast, and how to do so.)		A. Compares and contrasts similar personalities, events and texts in unlearned פסוקים. (See Appendix for items to compare and contrast, and how to do so.)	
4.05 Dividing Into Segments and Finding the Main Ideas							
	A. Divides one פסוק into clear segments, based on context and/or טעמי המקרא.						
B. Retells the content of a learned פסוק in their own words.		B. Divides one פסוק into clear segments, and can identify the main idea in the two halves of the same פסוק.					
	C. Retells the main idea of a story or group of פסוקים after the teacher identifies it.	C. Identifies the theme or main idea of a learned story or group of פסוקים from a list of options.		C. States the theme or main idea of a learned story or group of פסוקים, and lists supporting details.			
		D. Divides groups of פסוקים into segments or topics, based on content and context.		D. Divides an ענין into segments or topics, based on content, context, and variations in styles of text (as narratives, quotations, instructions and lists).			
		E. Summarizes a learned פסוק or group of פסוקים in student's own words (by distinguishing main ideas from details).		E. Summarizes a learned or unlearned group of פסוקים in student's own words (by distinguishing main ideas from details).		E. Summarizes a whole ענין (as grouped by פתוחות וסתומות) or more in students' own words (by distinguishing main ideas from details).	

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
4.06 Noticing Anomalies and Deviations in the Text							
	A. Recognizes seemingly extraneous language in the text after it was pointed out by the teacher, such as: • Repetition of words.[50] • Repetition of synonyms.[51]	A. Recognizes when facts are missing from the text as well as seemingly extraneous language, such as: • Repetition of words.[52] • Repetition of synonyms.[53]		A. Recognizes seemingly extraneous language as well as other anomalies in the text including: • Missing subject. • Missing objects. • Incomplete sentences. • Missing and extra letters. • Grammatical inconsistencies. • Difficulties in the narrative and logical flow of the text.			
4.07 Identifying Literal and Contextual Meanings							
		A. Identifies figurative language and explains its meaning after it has been explained by the teacher. (e.g. כחול הים)		A. Identifies figurative language when encountered in פסוקים, and explains the significance of the particular analogy being used.			
		B. Understands that דברה תורה בלשון בני אדם when encountering anthropomorphic language in learned פסוקים. (e.g. יד ה', ארדה נא)		B. Identifies anthropomorphic language when encountered in the פסוקים, and explains that דברה תורה בלשון בני אדם and the significance of the particular analogy being used.			

[50] I.e. "וילכו שניהם יחדיו" in בראשית כב:ו and again in פסוק ח .
[51] I.e. "פרו ורבו" in בראשית א:כב. See רש"י there.
[52] I.e. "וילכו שניהם יחדיו" in בראשית כב:ו and again in פסוק ח .
[53] I.e. "פרו ורבו" in בראשית א:כב. See רש"י there.

Integrating Knowledge

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
4.08 Integrating Knowledge and Ideas							
A. Can retell, in any mode (see Appendix for examples), the complete story of what was learned, as taught by the teacher, integrating multiple bits of knowledge and ideas in a single telling.		A. Combines various ideas and information learned from texts and commentaries introduced by the teacher, into a new communication (see Appendix for examples) which reflects comprehension, analysis and synthesis.		A. Combines various ideas and information learned from texts and commentaries and *personal research* into a new communication (see Appendix for examples) which reflects comprehension, analysis and synthesis.			

5. רש"י Skills

Learning רש"י is an integral component of learning חומש and fully understanding its פשט. Mastering רש"י skills requires fluency in its alphabet, its language, and its style. Close reading of the פסוקים should lead us to recognize the issues that רש"י will address and our need for his insight to complete our understanding.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. Understanding the biographical background and historical context of a given מפורש will help us better understand his teachings.	1. Who is this מפורש? / How does his biographical information impact his teachings?
2. מפורשים are part of תורה שבעל פה, helping us to understanding the חומש. All are sacred, and many were written with רוח הקדש.	2. Where did this מפורש get this from? / Is it okay to disagree with a מפורש? / What would I be missing in my understanding of the פסוק if I hadn't learned this?

Reading and Language Skills

The student will be able to read and translate רש"י.

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. Different texts and authors have their own styles, and familiarity with their styles enables us to navigate, understand and master these texts.	1. What language skills do I need in order to master רש"י?

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
5.01 רש"י Script							
	A. Identifies all letters of רש"י script correctly.	A. Identifies all letters of רש"י script correctly, and accurately transcribes all letters from any רש"י in רש"י script to handwriting script.		A. Accurately transcribes all letters from any רש"י in רש"י script to handwriting script.		A. Accurately transcribes all letters from any רש"י in רש"י script to handwriting script, adding נקודות.	
		B. Reads a רש"י in רש"י script with נקודות accurately.		B. Reads a רש"י in רש"י script with נקודות accurately and fluently.		B. Reads a רש"י in רש"י script without נקודות accurately and fluently.	
5.02 רש"י Abbreviations (ראשי תיבות)							
				A. Decipher and translate common רש"י abbreviations (from list in attached Appendix) which appear in the רש"יs that are learned.			
5.03 רש"י Vocabulary Skills							
				A. Translate vocabulary that is commonly used in רש"י (from list in attached Appendix), which appear in רש"יs that are learned.			
5.04 Group and Translate							
		A. Group and translate a רש"י as taught by the teacher.	A. Group and translate a רש"י after the teacher translated, but did not group it.	A. Group and translate short, basic and straightforward רש"יs – or portions of a longer רש"י – independently.		A. Group and translate רש"יs (including extensive and complex ones) independently.	

רש"י Comprehension Skills

The students will be able to:

- demonstrate an understanding of רש"י's methodology while analyzing the components of his commentary.
- use מפרשי רש"י to better understand רש"י's commentary

Enduring Understandings	Essential Questions
1. רש"י's commentary follows particular rules which are prerequisites for understanding רש"י.	1. Why do I need רש"י?/ What is רש"י trying to do?
2. "אני לא באתי לפרש אלא פשוטו של מקרא."	2. How would I understand this פסוק without רש"י?
3. Literal meaning is not necessarily פשט; sometimes the "simple" meaning of the פסוק requires a figurative or deeper understanding.	3. What is פשט? / What is the "פשט" of this פסוק?
4. Learning רש"י isn't an additional layer to our understanding but is a necessary component to complete our understanding.	4. What's bothering רש"י? / How does רש"י make this פסוק clearer?
5. Close reading of the text is necessary in order to know what is bothering רש"י.	5. How do the different elements and rules of רש"י help me find the information I need? / What clues should I be looking for? / What type of קושיא is רש"י addressing?[54]
6. רש"י's commentary is precise and concise, and has multiple layers, so we need מפרשי רש"י to fully understand and appreciate it.	6. Why do I need this מפורש on a מפורש? / How does this מפורש help me better understand the פסוק?

[54] See the kinds of anomalies and קושיאs listed in 4.7.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
5.05 Understanding רש"י							
		A. Explains the question and answer of רש"י in the פשט after it was explained by the teacher.		A. Explains the question and answer of רש"י in the פשט after it was translated by the teacher, and רש"י's question is easily understood.	A. Explains the questions and answer in learned רש"יs (including long רש"יs, and when there is more than one answer) and in unlearned (short and straightforward) רש"יs.	A. Explains the questions and answer in unlearned רש"יs, including long רש"יs, and when there is more than one answer.	
		B. Uses the דיבור המתחיל to identify רש"י's question in learned רש"יs, after this was pointed out by the teacher.	B. Uses the דיבור המתחיל to identify רש"י's question in learned רש"יs, when this was not pointed out by the teacher.	B. Uses the דיבור המתחיל to identify the question in unlearned (short and straightforward) רש"יs.		B. Uses the דיבור המתחיל and עיקר שפתי חכמים to identify the question in unlearned רש"יs.	
				C. Uses רש"י**'s** question to categorize the type of רש"י.[55]			

[55] There are some very distinct type of רש"יs, including but not limited to ones related to grammar, use of words, or logic of the storyline. See appendix for full explanation.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
					D. Explains the function of a דבר אחר and the need for two or more answers, when the teacher has pointed it out.	D. Explains the function of a דבר אחר and the need for two or more answers, referencing שפתי חכמים when necessary, for an unlearned רש"י.	
			E. Identifies what רש"י uses as a support for his answer, (whether it is from the פסוק, other פסוקים, a מדרש, or another source) in learned רש"יs after it was pointed it by the teacher.	E. Identifies what רש"י uses as a support for his answer, whether it is from the פסוק, other פסוקים, a מדרש, or another source, in learned or unlearned (short and straightforward) רש"יs, when it is evident.		E. Identifies what רש"י uses as a support for his answer, whether it is from the פסוק, other פסוקים, a מדרש, or another source, in unlearned (including long רש"יs with multiple sources) רש"יs, when it is evident.	
5.06 Summarizing רש"י							
		A. Restates רש"י's commentary in one's own words, for learned רש"יs.		A. Summarizes רש"י, stating the main idea in one's own words, in learned or unlearned (short and straightforward) רש"יs.		A. Summarizes רש"י's commentary stating the main idea(s) in one's own words , in learned or unlearned (including long and complex) רש"יs.	
		B. Explains the פסוק according to רש"י, when רש"י deals with translation or other factual clarifications, for learned רש"יs.		B. Explains the פסוק according to רש"י, for learned or unlearned (short and straightforward) רש"יs.		B. Explains the פסוק according to רש"י, for learned or unlearned (including long and complex) רש"יs.	

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
5.07 Dividing רש"י							
			A. Divides a learned רש"י into its various components (e.g. דיבור המתחיל, question, answer, supporting evidence).	A. Divides a learned or unlearned, (short and straightforward) רש"י into its various components (e.g. דיבור המתחיל, question, answer, supporting evidence).		A. Divides a learned or unlearned (including long and complex) רש"י into its various components (e.g. דיבור המתחיל, question, answer, supporting evidence).	
5.08 מפרשי רש"י[56]							
						A. For each of the מפרשי רש"י learned, explains the role of the commentary in relation to רש"י,[57] and its particular style or שיטה.	
						B. Navigates from רש"י or a particular portion of רש"י to the מפורש that comments on or relates to it.[58]	
						C. Explains the רש"י according to the מפרשי רש"י learned.	

[56] We recommend שפתי חכמים for grades 7 and 8. If a teacher chooses to advance further, they can go to גור אריה and רמב"ן.

[57] I.e. elucidate, argue, etc.

[58] E.g.: For שפתי חכמים, the small letters within רש"י. For תרגום, to find the quote in אונקלוס when רש"י says כתרגומו. For רמב"ן or גור אריה, to locate the same דיבור המתחיל.

6. מפרשים

Learning מפרשים allows for deeper engagement with the חומש text, particularly in the areas of higher order thinking. The more a student has mastered the skills of vocabulary, language, textual comprehension and understanding רש"י, the more they are prepared to appreciate the various levels of interpretation that additional commentaries bring to the text. There is also a new set of skills and knowledge that contribute to meaningful study of the מפרשים: It is crucial for students to understand their unique styles and approaches, and the tools of analysis or insight that they typically use, and it is helpful for them to learn about their biographical context.

Note to teachers: For the above reasons, we recommend that introducing מפרשים be postponed until students have consolidated their skills for independent learning of חומש and רש"י – typically, after eighth grade. However, we are introducing these standards here for classes that may be ready earlier, and to demonstrate the bridge from the grade 1-8 standards to more advanced, high school level study of the חומש.[59]

The student will be able to:

- Read, translate, and understand מפרשים
- Demonstrate knowledge of various commentators' backgrounds and methodology in order to analyze components of the commentary.
- Compare and contrast various מפרשים

Enduring Understandings	**Essential Questions**
1. Understanding the biographical background and historical context of a given מפרש will help us better understand his teachings.	1. Who is this מפרש? / How does his biographical information impact his teachings?
2. מפרשים are part of תורה שבעל פה, helping us to understanding the חומש. All are sacred, and many were written with רוח הקדש.	2. Where did this מפרש get this from? / Is it okay to disagree with a מפרש? / What would I be missing in my understanding of the פסוק if I hadn't learned this?
3. Different מפרשים address different levels of פרד"ס, and have a unique approach to the text.	3. What level of פרד"ס does this מפרש address? / What is this מפרש doing?
4. Every מפרש has its own structure and "key" which enables us to navigate and understand it.	4. How is this מפרש structured? / How does the structure of this מפרש reflect its purpose?

[59] For schools that choose to introduce מפרשים, we recommend that you begin with these, as mentioned earlier: שפתי חכמים, בעל הטורים and רמב"ן.

5. Every מפרש has a distinct style, approach and mode of expression.	5. What do I need to know about the style, approach and language of this מפרש to learn and understand it?

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
6.01 Identifying the מפרשים[60]							
						A. For each of the מפרשים learned, states the title of the מפרש, the name of its author, and the time period and area that he lived in.	
						B. For each of the מפרשים learned, identifies which level of פרד"ס it generally addresses, as well as any other distinctive role that it plays,[61] and explains how this is evident in a learned מפרש.	
6.02 Reading and Translating מפרשים							
						A. For each of the מפרשים learned, translates key, repeating vocabulary words that are encountered in the learning.	

[60] Navigation of the מפרשים is not included here, but goes under the umbrella of Text Referencing Skills, in Standard 1.9 D.

[61] E.g. to elucidate פשט, or to argue with רש"י.

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	Level 6	Level 7	Level 8
						B. For each of the מפרשים learned, reads (without translating) an unlearned מפרש *with* נקודות fluently and accurately, or a learned מפרש *without* נקודות fluently and accurately.	
6.03 Understanding מפרשים							
						A. When applicable, states the question and answer of a מפרש.	
						B. When applicable, divides the מפרש into its parts – e.g. question, answer, proof, citation, etc.	
						C. Summarizes a מפרש in one's own words, stating its main idea.	
						D. Explains the פסוק according to the interpretation of one or more learned מפרשים.	
6.04 Comparing and Contrasting מפרשים							
						A. Compares and contrasts the styles and approaches of different מפרשים, bringing examples from מפרשים learned.	
						B. Compares and contrasts the various מפרשים on a single פסוק or issue.	